



Road to fifth title dotted with experiments and cautious optimism

Head coach Craig Fulton could have considered resting more members from the Paris squad and introducing **fresh faces**, even if it meant risking a few losses.

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In 2023, roughly six months after a forgettable ninth-place finish at the World Cup, the Indian men's hockey team had its first major test at the Asian Champions Trophy in Chennai under Craig Fulton, the successor of coach Graham Reid. The Men in Blue did have a few hiccups, including a two-goal deficit in the final against Malaysia at one point,

but managed to clinch the title in front of the home crowd.

The successful title defence at the 2024 edition, held in Moqi, China, from September 8 to 17, is the latest achievement, signifying the team's consistent growth under Fulton in